

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management Administrative functions and various tiers of government and international politics

Week 3-4

Administrative Structure of Bangladesh

Bangladesh has a two-tier administrative system:

1. Central Secretariat (National Level)

- This is where the main government functions are organized.
- **Key Positions:**
 - **Secretary:** Heads a ministry.
 - **Additional Secretary:** Assists the Secretary.
 - **Joint Secretary:** Supports multiple departments.
 - **Deputy Secretary:** Manages specific tasks.
 - **Assistant Secretary:** Handles day-to-day operations.

2. Field Administration (Sub-national Level)

- Responsible for local governance and service delivery.
- **Key Positions:**
 - **Divisional Commissioner (DC):** Oversees divisions.
 - **Additional Divisional Commissioner (ADC):** Assists the DC.
 - **Thana Nirbahi Officer (TNO):** Manages local areas (upazilas).
 - **Magistrate & Assistant Commissioner:** Enforce laws and manage local issues.

Foreign Policy of Bangladesh

- **Definition:** Foreign policy is a country's strategy for dealing with other nations to protect its interests.
- It serves as a guide for international relations.

Determinants of Bangladesh's Foreign Policy

1. Internal Factors:

- **Size:** Both geographic and population size matter.
- **Geography:** Location and natural resources influence decisions.
- **Culture & History:** Shared values and past events shape relations.
- **Economic Development:** Affects global interactions.
- **Social Structure:** Divisions within society can impact policy.
- **Public Mood:** Citizens' opinions can sway decisions.
- **Technology:** Advances can enhance or limit foreign capabilities.

2. External Factors:

- **Power Structure:** Global power dynamics influence decisions.
- **International Organizations:** Membership in groups like the UN shapes policies.

Foreign Policy Decision-Making Process

In Bangladesh, foreign policy decisions involve both formal and informal institutions:

- **Formal Institutions:**
 - **National Assembly & President:** Key decision-makers.
 - **Prime Minister:** Leads policy direction.
 - **Ministries:** Various departments like Foreign Affairs and Defense play roles.
- **Informal Institutions:**
 - **Political Parties:** Influence through public opinion.

- **Press and Media:** Shape perceptions and inform citizens.

This structure ensures that both official channels and public sentiment are considered in foreign policy decisions.